🧭 First-Launch Orientation — Feature Spec

Status: Proposed

Triggered by: Nicole — understands TQF from the App Store description, lost once inside the app

Priority: High — retention risk at first open

Problem

The App Store description works. Users download the app knowing what it is. Then they open it, see five tabs with no explanation, and lose the thread.

This is not a brand problem. It is a handoff problem — from "I get the concept" to "I know what I'm looking at."

The fix is lightweight: one orientation card on first open, and a one-line label the first time each tab is visited. Both disappear permanently. Neither is a tutorial.

One app update, both features together

Both features require a new app binary — new components, new logic, EAS build, App Store and Google Play review. There is no server-side shortcut for either. The tab micro-labels live entirely in the app code: the copy, the fade timing, the AsyncStorage flags.

Ship them in the same update. One build, one review cycle.

The only backend change is a small addition to an existing endpoint (see below).

How first-open detection works

When the app calls `GET /api/billing/status?installId=...` on boot, the backend already has the `installId`. It can tell whether this is the first time it has seen that ID.

Backend change: Add `isNewInstall: boolean` to the response.

- `true` on the first call for a given `installId`
- `false` on every call after that
- No new database table needed

App change: If `isNewInstall: true`, show the orientation card and write `orientationSeen: true` to AsyncStorage. The local flag is a safety net — the card never shows again even if the flag behaves unexpectedly.

Reinstalls get a new `installId`, which correctly triggers a fresh orientation experience.

Feature 1 — Orientation card

Shown once, on first open, before the user interacts with any tab. Full-screen overlay. Tap anywhere to dismiss. Never shown again.

Not a carousel. Not a walkthrough. Not a permission gate.

Design

- Full-screen black background (`#000000`)
- Optional: TQF photo behind at low opacity, same as the paywall aesthetic
- No title, no "Welcome to TQF" — start directly with the list
- Tab names in white, descriptions in white at 60% opacity
- Left-aligned, system font, undecorated
- "tap anywhere to begin" at the bottom in the smallest body size, accent blue (`#4DB8FF`)
- No auto-dismiss — the user decides when to move on

English

```
Five things. One frame.

Today      — where you are right now. What the day carries.
Pulse      — the signals shaping it. Lunar, solar, geomagne
tic, circadian.
Wisdom     — what to hold. Echo cards and Cookie, drawn fro
m today.
```

```
Upcoming   — patterns worth knowing in advance.
Settings   — your location, your language, your theme.

tap anywhere to begin
```

French (informal — tu)

```
Cinq choses. Un cadre.

Aujourd'hui  — ou tu es maintenant. Ce que la journee port
e.
Pouls        — les signaux qui la facon ent. Lunaire, solai
re, geomag etique, circadien.
Sagesse      — ce qu'il faut garder. Les cartes echo et Coo
kie, tires d'aujourd'hui.
A venir      — des cycles a connaitre a l'avance.
Reglages     — ton lieu, ta langue, ton theme.

touche n'importe ou pour commencer
```

Spanish

```
Cinco cosas. Un marco.

Hoy            — donde estas ahora. Lo que lleva el dia.
Pulso          — las senales que lo forman. Lunar, solar, g
eomagnetica, circadiana.
Sabiduria      — lo que vale guardar. Cartas eco y Cookie,
nacidas de hoy.
Proximamente   — ciclos que vale la pena conocer con antela
cion.
Ajustes        — tu lugar, tu idioma, tu tema.

toca en cualquier lugar para empezar
```

Portuguese

```
Cinco coisas. Um enquadramento.

Hoje          — onde voce esta agora. O que o dia carrega.
Pulso         — os sinais que o moldam. Lunar, solar, geoma
gnetico, circadiano.
Sabedoria     — o que vale guardar. Cartas eco e Cookie, na
scidas de hoje.
Em breve      — ciclos que vale conhecer com antecedencia.
Configuracoes — seu lugar, seu idioma, seu tema.

toque em qualquer lugar para comecar
```

German

```
Funf Dinge. Ein Rahmen.

Heute         — wo du jetzt bist. Was der Tag mit sich brin
gt.
Puls          — die Signale, die ihn pragen. Lunar, solar,
geomagnetisch, zirkadian.
Weisheit      — was es zu halten gilt. Echo-Karten und Cook
ie, aus dem heutigen Tag.
Demnachst     — Muster, die es sich lohnt im Voraus zu kenn
en.
Einstellungen — dein Ort, deine Sprache, dein Thema.

tippe irgendwo, um zu beginnen
```

Italian

```
Cinque cose. Una cornice.

Oggi            — dove sei adesso. Cio che il giorno porta
con se.
Impulso         — i segnali che lo modellano. Lunare, solar
e, geomagnetico, circadiano.
Saggezza        — cosa vale tenere. Carte eco e Cookie, nat
```

```
e da oggi.
In arrivo       — cicli che vale la pena conoscere in antic
ipo.
Impostazioni    — il tuo luogo, la tua lingua, il tuo tema.

tocca ovunque per iniziare
```

Feature 2 — Tab micro-labels

The first time a user opens Pulse, Wisdom, or Upcoming, a single line of text appears at the top of the tab content, below the title. It fades out after 4 seconds or on first scroll. It never comes back.

Stored in AsyncStorage: `pulseIntroSeen`, `wisdomIntroSeen`, `upcomingIntroSeen`.

Today and Settings need no label — their purpose is clear from the content.

English

Tab	Text
Pulse	Signals shaping today — lunar, solar, geomagnetic, circadian. No prescriptions.
Wisdom	Echo cards drawn from today's signals. Cookie is ancient wisdom meeting this moment.
Upcoming	Three horizons: Soon (48h), Cycle (14 days), Season (90 days). Switch at the top.

French (informal — tu)

Tab	Text
Pouls	Les signaux qui fac onnent aujourd'hui — lunaire, solaire, geomagnetique, circadien. Aucune prescription.
Sagesse	Des cartes echo issues des signaux du jour. Cookie est une sagesse ancienne qui rencontre ce moment.
A venir	Trois horizons : Bientot (48h), Cycle (14 jours), Saison (90 jours). Change en haut.

Spanish

Tab	Text
Pulso	Senales que dan forma al dia — lunar, solar, geomagnetica, circadiana. Sin prescripciones.
Sabiduria	Cartas eco nacidas de las senales de hoy. Cookie es sabiduria antigua que encuentra este momento.
Proximamente	Tres horizontes: Pronto (48h), Ciclo (14 dias), Estacion (90 dias). Cambia arriba.

Portuguese

Tab	Text
Pulso	Sinais que moldam o dia — lunar, solar, geomagnetico, circadiano. Sem prescricoes.
Sabedoria	Cartas eco nascidas dos sinais de hoje. Cookie e sabedoria antiga encontrando este momento.
Em breve	Tres horizontes: Em breve (48h), Ciclo (14 dias), Estacao (90 dias). Mude no topo.

German

Tab	Text
Puls	Signale, die den Tag pragen — lunar, solar, geomagnetisch, zirkadian. Keine Vorschriften.
Weisheit	Echo-Karten aus den Signalen des heutigen Tages. Cookie ist alte Weisheit, die diesen Moment trifft.
Demnachst	Drei Horizonte: Bald (48h), Zyklus (14 Tage), Saison (90 Tage). Oben wechseln.

Italian

Tab	Text
Impulso	Segnali che modellano il giorno — lunare, solare, geomagnetico, circadiano. Nessuna prescrizione.
Saggezza	Carte eco nate dai segnali di oggi. Cookie e saggezza antica che incontra questo momento.
In arrivo	Tre orizzonti: Presto (48h), Ciclo (14 giorni), Stagione (90 giorni). Cambia in alto.

Implementation

Component	Change	Effort
Backend `/api/billing/status`	Add `isNewInstall: boolean`	Small
App boot logic	Read flag, write `orientationSeen` to AsyncStorage	Small
`OrientationCard` component	Full-screen overlay, reuses existing visual system	Small-Medium
Tab micro-labels	3 x AsyncStorage flags + fade-out text per tab	Small

Estimated total: 1-2 hours in Replit. One build, one review cycle.

Drafted March 12, 2026. Nicole's feedback.